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 **Rain 58/53 • Tomorrow: Rain 57/56 B18** *Democracy Dies in Darkness* **FRIDAY, MAY 22, 2026 • \$4**

U.S. drains munitions for Israel's protection

Hundreds of THAADs expended, about half of Pentagon's inventory

BY JOHN HUDSON

The U.S. military has depleted much of its inventory of advanced missile-defense interceptors after expending far more high-end munitions defending Israel amid hostilities with Iran than Israeli forces used themselves, according to Defense Department assessments described to The Washington Post.

The imbalance, according to three U.S. officials who spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive security matters, underscores the extent to which Washington has shouldered the burden of countering Iranian ballistic missile strikes during Operation Epic Fury, and raises questions about U.S. military readiness and security commitments around the world.

The United States launched more than 200 Terminal High Altitude Area Defense, or THAAD, interceptors in defense of Israel — roughly half of the Pentagon's total inventory — along with more than 100 Standard Missile-3 and Standard Missile-6 interceptors fired from naval vessels in the eastern Mediterranean, said the U.S. officials, who, like others in this article, spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss sensitive security matters. By contrast, Israel fired fewer than 100 of its Arrow interceptors and around 90 David's Sling interceptors, some of which were used against less sophisticated projectiles fired by Iran-backed groups in Yemen and Lebanon.

Military analysts said the data described to The Post offers a rare window into how the United States and Israel work together.

"The numbers are striking," said Kelly Grieco, a senior fellow at the Stimson Center. "The United States absorbed most of the missile defense mission while Israel conserved its own magazines. Even if the operational logic was sound, the United States is left with roughly 200 THAAD interceptors and a production line that can't keep pace with demand."

SEE ISRAEL ON A11

Honors for the fallen



MATT MCCLAIN/REUTERS

First Sgt. Kosovare Fain is handed a flag by her daughter Reagan Fain, 4, as soldiers from the U.S. Army 3d Infantry Regiment, known as The Old Guard, participate in the annual "Flags In" event at Arlington National Cemetery, in which about 250,000 American flags are placed at headstones and elsewhere in advance of Memorial Day.

Despite AI fears, U.S. layoffs are roughly normal

Headlines, explanations about cuts can distort real ills of job market

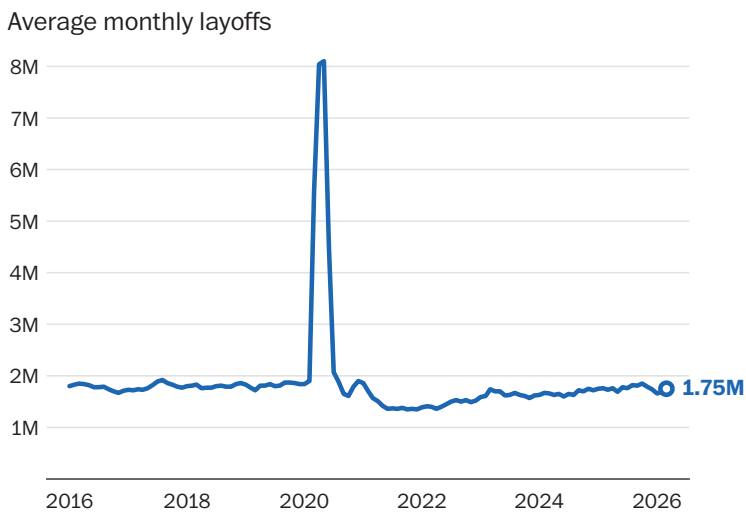
BY SHIRA OVIDE
AND RACHEL LERMAN

Jobs can feel precarious right now as well-known companies keep slashing workers.

The latest is Meta, which promised it would cut jobs this month and on Wednesday sent layoff notices to about 10 percent of its staff, nearly 8,000 people, according to news reports.

Like some other technology companies, Meta has attributed the layoffs partly to the effects of artificial intelligence. They follow job cuts from Amazon, Wall

Layoffs are not spiking



Seasonally adjusted 3-month rolling average. The numbers also include firings for cause.

Source: Calculations from Bureau of Labor Statistics data SHIRA OVIDE / THE WASHINGTON POST

Street banks, Oracle, Nike and UPS. Meta didn't respond to a request for comment about the layoffs. (Jeff Bezos, Amazon's executive chairman, owns The Washington Post.)

But headline-grabbing layoffs and corporate justifications can give a misleading impression about what ails America's job market and AI's role in that. It could lead people to misjudge their career prospects or financial risks.

The numbers show that layoffs in the U.S. are roughly at or below levels from before the pandemic, although they are higher than in 2022 when businesses snapped up workers as the economy roared back to life.

In the three months ended in March, an average of 1.75 million Americans were laid off each

SEE LAYOFFS ON A9

Senate GOP rebuffs Trump

ISING FRUSTRATION OVER PAYOUT FUND

Votes derailed on money for border and ballroom

BY JARRELL DILLARD,
RILEY BEGGIN
AND THEODORIC MEYER

Republicans postponed their plans to pass tens of billions of dollars in additional funding for immigration enforcement agencies Thursday after widespread frustration over a new \$1.8 billion "Anti-Weaponization Fund" derailed the bill.

Senate Republicans peppered acting attorney general Todd Blanche with questions about the payout fund during a lunch meeting Thursday, according to two Senate GOP aides familiar with the meeting, including who would be eligible for the money and what guardrails would exist to prevent people convicted of attacking the Capitol on Jan. 6, 2021, from benefiting.

The two aides, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe internal negotiations, said Blanche did not adequately answer those questions. Senate Republicans didn't feel they could move forward with their funding bill without a plan on how or whether they would address the new fund in the legislation, they said. White House officials "need to help with this issue, because we have a lot of members who are concerned," Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-South Dakota) told reporters after the meeting.

Republicans had been rushing

SEE BALLROOM ON A4

250-foot arch: A panel friendly to Trump approves the project. **B12**

Trump allies are lining up for a slice of \$1.8B windfall

BY MERYL KORNFIELD

Mark McCloskey is eagerly waiting for details to emerge on how to apply for the Trump administration's new \$1.8 billion settlement fund, both for himself and for the Jan. 6 rioters he represents as a lawyer. "Everybody's very excited about it," McCloskey said. "It's the first ray of light we've seen in a long time."

McCloskey gained national notoriety in 2020, after viral videos showed him and his wife standing outside their St. Louis home, pointing guns at demonstrators protesting racial injustice. The next year, the couple pleaded guilty to misdemeanor charges. Even though he was pardoned by the Missouri governor, McCloskey said his reputation was damaged; Google results describe him as "former personal injury lawyer" even though he still practices, so he is considering applying for the "anti-weaponization fund."

Since that incident in 2020, one of his legal causes has been aiding people prosecuted for their actions during the Jan. 6, 2021, insurrection at the U.S. Capitol. Last year, he said he advocated for a fund to support

SEE FUND ON A5

DNC releases, disavows autopsy of 2024 defeat

Report advises overhaul and argues White House under Biden failed Harris

BY DAN MERICA
AND HANNAH KNOWLES

The Democratic National Committee released a long-awaited autopsy of the party's failed 2024 presidential campaign on Thursday, but party leaders took the awkward position of asserting that the report itself "does not meet our standards."

The report was released "for full transparency," according to DNC Chair Ken Martin, who has faced months of anger over his earlier decision to withhold it. But the document, described by party officials as a draft, opens with the DNC disavowing its contents and stating it "cannot independently verify the claims presented."

While it might be tempting for Democrats to point to narrow margins of defeat for Kamala Harris and downballot candidates and argue they need to tweak rather than overhaul their approach, the report says, this "denialist" thinking "prevents the Party from seeking real accountability" and making necessary changes.

The report, which was prepared by Democratic strategist Paul Rivera, argues that the White House, under President Joe Biden, did not do enough to set Harris up for political success.

"The White House did not position or prepare the Vice President," the report says. "Had the White House explored and evaluated ways to leverage Kamala Harris earlier in the administration, perhaps it would have improved the President's standing, and it certainly could have helped prepare her to lead the ticket."

The White House told the DNC to do polling ahead of the 2022

SEE DNC ON A4



LEE JIN-MAN/AP

Stone-faced and all business — until victory

North Korea's Naegohyang Women's FC players celebrate Wednesday after defeating South Korea's Suwon FC in Suwon, South Korea. Tension around the women's match — a rare athletic clash between the countries — underscores the low point that inter-Korean relations have reached. **Story, A10**

IN THE NEWS

'Super ager' gets sheepskin Billie Jean King, who reached No. 1 in the world tennis ranking and won 39 Grand Slam titles, at 82 finished her college degree after six decades. **A2**

Mosque attack A first-person video offers a brutal glimpse into the latest deadly assault on an American house of worship. **A3**

THE NATION
The Supreme Court dismissed a death penalty case on people with mental disabilities. **A6**
The president rolled back rules on climate super pollutants, saying it will cut costs. **A6**

THE WORLD
An Israeli minister drew a global rebuke over his treatment of flotilla activists. **A11**
Ebola responders say cuts by Western nations left them ill-equipped for the outbreak. **A12**

THE ECONOMY
The president delayed an executive order on AI oversight, creating uncertainty about how the administration will respond to a new breed of powerful models. **A18**
All three indexes erased early drops and gained strength following a U-turn for oil prices. **A18**

STYLE
A live TV gaffe with an inadvertent spoiler turned the "Survivor 50" finale into a fitting train wreck of missteps. **B1**

SPORTS
With reigning champ Carlos Alcaraz out injured, Jannik Sinner is the men's favorite in the French Open. **B7**

THE REGION
A carjacking and shooting rampage with more than a dozen victims terrorized Pr. George's. **B12**

WEEKEND
The 32 most anticipated movies of the summer. Spider-Man and the Minions are back, but the season might belong to Odysseus and aliens.

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